

Friday, September 9

Troubles. Augusta was here at 7:55. She sits in the living room and laughs at Matthew while Cheryl and I prepare to leave. She had rain on her coat and hat. Cheryl planned to pick up Deena Millar. The car wouldn't start. We woke up Maureen Bingham for a boost. We weren't too late.

Cheryl has a better idea about her assignment. Science, Health, Grades Seven and Eight Art. My schedule flows smoothly: a whole morning of English, most afternoons are Social Studies and a little Art and Music. Cheryl was by the school at 4 to pick me up. I was meeting with Carl Krause about the class list. She was exhausted by the boys. They have been a handful all day. We drove home. Cheryl got some food for Matthew, then we went to the Cave for a \$10 pizza.

Peter had to go to the bathroom in the middle of the meal. I grumbled something about not needing to do this every time we go out, and when Peter asked me what I said, I answered, "I was just talking to myself."

He said, "What were you saying?"

"Oh Peter, well I guess you don't need to run to the bathroom every time you go to the restaurant." He tugged his lip downward. "That's not talking to yourself. That's talking to me."

We got home at 6. Peter had a long bath. Matthew spent his time sitting here, walking there and diving off the sofa. I stopped him from making the last step onto a stereo speaker. It's hard to keep him from climbing. I watched the Rider-Ottawa game. After Peter's bath I read to him. We went a fair distance with Taran, Gwydion and Gurgi. After describing Gurgi's appearance and self-pitying behavior Peter was chuckling. I asked him if he could picture Gurgi. He was holding his knees and pressing his eyes into his legs, thinking.

Suddenly he pulled his head back and smiled. "I can't see Gurgi. All I can see is E.T."

After listening to Gurgi moan about hunger and needing food, begging Gwydion for something, I asked Peter what he would have done were he the prince. "Well, when you've got to eat you've got to eat."

Matthew went down quickly. I didn't hear a word from him. I came out, watched the last minute of the game, visited with Cheryl, and we watched *My Father the Fullback* (1949) with Fred MacMurray. The vocabulary and styles of a 1949 university football family are hilarious. I fell asleep before the end. We went to bed in the middle of a storm. I had to run outside in the rain to secure a banging back gate.